



Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

We ask you to refrain from playing on the playground during worship; you are welcome to use it after worship (as long as you are small enough to fit on the equipment!)

*** Please rise in body or spirit**

Gathering Music

Bless the Beasts and Children

©1971 Barry DeVorzon & Perry Botkin Jr ; Screen Gems – EMI Music Inc. (BMI)
Reprinted with permission under CCS License #: 11563. All rights reserved.

Greeting

*Call to Worship

Leader: Let us rejoice with the Creator at the wonderful creation around us.

People: Let us sing to the Lord a new song; a song for all the creatures of the earth.

Leader: Let us rejoice in the goodness of God shown in the beauty of little things.

People: Let us marvel at the little creatures who are innocent in God's sight.

Leader: Let us praise God's handiwork in the complexity of their lives.

People: Let us not be too full of ourselves to praise the Lord of little things.

Leader: Let us rejoice in the other worlds, sublime and mysterious, that God has made.

People: The world of earthworms burrowing in the ground;

Leader: The world of skylarks soaring above us;

People: The world of foxes playing around their dens.

All: Let us hear God rejoicing throughout the whole earth: "The earth is mine, and all that is within it."

*Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #147

All Things Bright and Beautiful

Martin Shaw (1915)

Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

Refrain:

All things bright and beautiful, all creatures great and small,
all things wise and wonderful: the Lord God made them all.

Each little flower that opens, each little bird that sings,
God made their glowing colors, and made their tiny wings. (Refrain)

The purple-headed mountains, the river running by,
the sunset and the morning that brightens up the sky. (Refrain)

The cold wind in the winter, the pleasant summer sun,
the ripe fruits in the garden: God made them every one. (Refrain)

God gave us eyes to see them, and lips that we might tell
how great is God Almighty, who has made all things well. (Refrain)

Passing the Peace

Prayers

Sharing of Joys & Concerns

Morning Prayer

O God, we thank you for all the creatures you have made, so perfect in their kind-- great animals like the elephant and the rhinoceros, humorous animals like the camel and the monkey, friendly ones like the dog and the cat, working ones like the horse and the ox, active ones like the squirrel and the rabbit, majestic ones like the lion and the tiger, for soaring and twittering birds with their songs. O Lord give us such love for your creation, that love may cast out fear, and all creatures see in us their protector and friend, through Jesus Christ our Lord. *Amen.*

Silent Prayers

Pastoral Prayer

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

Our Creator, God in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom* come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive
those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power
and the glory forever. *Amen.*

*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.

Scripture Reading

Song of Solomon 2:8-13

Anne Marie Johnson

*Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal #92 vv. 1-4, 6

For the Beauty of the Earth

Folliot S. Pierpoint (1864) Conrad Kocher (1838)

Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

For the beauty of the earth, for the glory of the skies,
for the love which from our birth over and around us lies;

Refrain:

Lord of all, to thee we raise this our hymn of grateful praise.

For the beauty of each hour of the day and of the night,
hill and vale, and tree and flower, sun and moon, and stars of light; (Refrain)

For the joy of ear and eye, for the heart and mind's delight,
for the mystic harmony linking sense to sound and sight; (Refrain)

For the joy of human love, brother, sister, parent, child,
friends on earth and friends above, for all gentle thoughts and mild; (Refrain)

For thyself, best Gift Divine, to the world so freely given,
for that great, great love of thine, peace on earth, and joy in heaven: (Refrain)

Message

"Blessings of the Natural World"

Rev. Becky Sechrist

Offertory

All God's Critters Got a Place in the Choir

©1979 Bill Staines ; Mineral River Music (BMI) Janet Wheeler (PRS) (ASCAP)
Reprinted with permission under CCS License #: 11563. All rights reserved.

All God's critters got a place in the choir
Some sing low, some sing higher, some
Sing out loud on the telephone wires, and
Some just clap their hands, or paws, or anything they got now

Prayer of Dedication

In faith and gratitude we return these gifts that they may proclaim the mystery of your love and glorify the gospel. May hearts and lives be drawn to you by the witness our offerings will make in this community of faith and among all people you call us to serve. Amen.

Blessing of Animals

Benediction

Traveling Music

And Your Bird Can Sing

©1966 John Lennon, Paul McCartney; Sony/ATV Tunes LLC (ASCAP)
Reprinted with permission under CCS License #: 11563. All rights reserved.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*
Alex Rack, *Choir Director*; Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*;
Nicholas Sabah, *Communion Steward*

Lyrics and music reprinted under CCLI/OneLicense.net #A-711192.

All rights reserved.

Permission to podcast/stream the music in this service obtained from:

ONE LICENSE, License #A-711192; CCLI License No. 3175826; CCS License #: 11563

All rights reserved.

Announcements

We are delighted you are here! And, to minimize the handing around of things, we invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically. If you point your camera phone at the QR code below, it will take you to a google form where you can enter your information. If you don't have a camera phone, there are sign in sheets at the tables where you found bulletins.

For our offering, there are buckets for your cash or check offerings on the tables where you picked up your bulletin. You can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



MUMC DONATION



New in our prayers:

- **Hospice:** Joan Ellison

Holding in prayer:

- **Hospitalized:** Valerie Mayer's father
- **Recuperating after surgery:** Jan Hougen
- **Hospice:** Eric Schlensker
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Sigrid Skaaland, Carol Spearman, Kate Stower

OLD FASHIONED Church Rummage Sale

Lots of great stuff!
Housewares & Linens.
Toys. Books. Electronics.
And more!
(But no clothes)



Thursday, Friday & Saturday
Sept. 9, 10 & 11

Day	Date	Time
Thursday	September 9	9:00 a.m. - 8:00 p.m.
Friday	September 10	9:00 a.m. - 3:00 p.m.
Saturday	September 11	9:00 a.m. - 3:00 p.m.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street • MPLS • 612-721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org

Help! Yes, Help with the Rummage Sale! Bring your rummage (not clothes or large furniture items; all in working condition) to church on Sunday, Aug. 29 or Sept. 5 as we have nowhere to store things before that. Help price and prepare on Sept. 6, 7, 8 and help sell on Sept. 9, 10, and 11. Please let Maureen Trepp or Kim Kanuit know you are helping!!

Worship in September: Worship in September will look a lot like it does now! We will continue with one worship service, outside, at 10:00. If it is raining, then we will move inside to the sanctuary and ask that you wear a mask. Our goal is to return to 2 worship services in October, but stay tuned!

Masks required inside: We are amending our mask policy by requiring everyone to wear masks in our common areas in the building (this includes the sanctuary, narthex, fellowship hall, kitchen, bathrooms, etc.). Small groups that are meeting behind closed doors may still choose to make masks optional for the duration of their gathering.

Adult Zoom Class on Beliefs: This fall, there will be a class held on zoom on Monday nights that explores what we do, and don't, believe. Based on the book *What's the Least I Can Believe and Still Be a Christian* by Martin Thielen, we'll spend 5 weeks looking at the things we don't believe, and 5 weeks looking at things we do believe, with a final week to wrap it all up. Classes start on Sept. 13 and end on November 29. If you are interested, please buy the book and read chapters 1 & 2 prior to Sept. 13. Please also contact Becky for the zoom link to the class.

Adult In Person Class on Rules: We are spending a lot of time in our country determining, debating, and defying the various rules that help us be community. In the midst of this national conversation (confrontation), you are invited to take a step back in time and study the rules that guided the early Hebrew community. We'll gather on Tuesday afternoons at 2:00 from September 14 through October 12 in person at the church, and there will also be an online option. If you are interested in joining through zoom, please let Becky know prior to September 14 so she can get the technology set up appropriately. The first class will be introductory, with your reading assignments for each week coming after that.